T LEVEL GUIDE

Parent and carer guide

If your child is thinking about a T Level, here's what you need to know, and a few questions that are worth asking.

What is a T Level?

A T Level is a 2-year course for 16 to 19 year olds, taken after GCSEs. It's a Level 3 qualification, the same size as 3 A levels. Each one focuses on a single area of work, such as Digital, Business, Finance or Engineering, so your child learns skills that employers actually use.

How their time is spent

Most of the course, about 80%, is in the classroom. The other 20% is an industry placement with a real employer. The placement lasts at least 315 hours, which is about 45 days. Some colleges run it as one block, others as a day a week, and some mix the two.

Will they be paid on placement?

Not necessarily. There's no legal requirement for employers to pay T Level students, although some choose to. It's worth asking the college what's usual for the placements they arrange.

What about English and maths?

If your child hasn't got grade 4 in English and maths yet, they'll keep working towards it during the course. They don't need it to pass their T Level.

What can it lead to?

- A skilled job
- A higher or degree apprenticeship
- A higher-level course, or university

Questions worth asking the college

- How will you find my child's placement, and how will you support them while they're there?
- Who should we contact if there's a problem during the placement?
- How will we hear about how they're getting on?

Information from TLevels.gov.uk and GOV.UK, correct in October 2026.